



INTERNATIONAL

TRADE | GEOPOLITICS | INDIA-US RELATIONS

GLOBAL POLITICS

CHINA | BRICS | SPECULATION

US House clears Russia sanctions bill; 100% tariff power could impact India

Bill gives President authority to impose tariffs up to 100% on countries buying Russian oil; India says energy security remains a priority

Washington: The US House of Representatives has passed a bipartisan bill that gives President Donald Trump the authority to impose tariffs of up to 100% on countries that continue to buy Russian oil, a move that could include India and China.

The legislation aims to increase economic pressure on Russia over the war in Ukraine. While the bill does not automatically impose new tariffs, it enables the President to do so, based on national security and foreign policy assessments.

India has reiterated that its energy security, national interests and market stability remain a priority and that it will take all necessary measures to safeguard them.



WHAT THE US BILL MEANS

- Authorises tariffs up to 100% on countries buying Russian oil
- Targets major buyers, including India and China
- Not an automatic tariff – decision rests with the US President
- Aims to cut Russia's war funding and increase diplomatic pressure
- Could impact India-US trade if implemented

INDIA'S RESPONSE

- Energy security remains a priority
- Will take necessary steps to protect national interests
- Engaging with all stakeholders
- Monitoring global energy and trade developments

Xi Jinping health claims spark global speculation; China says President is working normally

Unverified reports of stroke surface after BRICS summit; Chinese Foreign Ministry denies rumours

Beijing: Speculation about Chinese President Xi Jinping's health has intensified after unverified social media claims suggested that he suffered a stroke following the BRICS summit and was taken to a military hospital.

The claims, originating from exiled Chinese political activists, have not been independently verified. China's Foreign Ministry has rejected the rumours, stating that President Xi has returned to Beijing and is working normally, attending official engagements.

Global observers say the rumours reflect ongoing scrutiny of China's leadership but analysts caution that there is no confirmed information on any serious health issue.

“Our energy policy is guided by the need to provide energy to the people of India.” — Jethi Jagdishram



WHAT WE KNOW

- Health claims are unverified
- China says President Xi is working normally
- No official confirmation of any stroke
- Analysts believe speculation will continue given China's opaque political system

“President Xi has returned to Beijing and is carrying out his official duties.” — Chinese Foreign Ministry

NATIONAL | LEADERSHIP | SERVICE | NATION FIRST

PM Modi turns 76; nationwide seva campaign unites millions

Month-long 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan' launched from today; focus on service, inclusion and developed India

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi turned 76 today, with celebrations across the country. The BJP has launched a month-long 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan' from September 17 to October 17, featuring blood donation drives, health camps, public outreach, youth programmes, cleanliness drives and welfare initiatives.

Special events are being held in Varanasi, Vadnagar and across all states, with participation from party workers, citizens and community organisations.



“Service to the people is the greatest form of nation building.” — Narendra Modi Prime Minister of India

KEY INITIATIVES (17 SEPT – 17 OCT)

- Blood donation camps
- Health & wellness programmes
- Youth & women outreach
- Cleanliness drives
- Support for vulnerable sections
- Nationwide participation

Sewa for a Stronger, Developed India

TELANGANA | ASSEMBLY | GOVERNANCE | 22-A LANDS

Revanth Reddy vows action on 22-A land irregularities

Says government will recover encroached land and allot to eligible poor, especially Dalits

Hyderabad: Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy, speaking in the Assembly on Wednesday, made strong remarks on prohibited properties under Section 22-A, alleging irregularities in land around former CM K. Chandrababbar Rao's Erravelli farmhouse and other parcels.

He said the government will conduct a detailed inquiry, recover encroached land and allot it to eligible poor beneficiaries, particularly Dalits. The Chief Minister emphasised transparency and accountability in land matters.



“No one is above the law. Government land belongs to the people and will be protected.” — A. Revanth Reddy Chief Minister, Telangana

TELANGANA | POLITICAL RESPONSE

BRS leaders counter Revanth; seek judicial probe into allegations

Demand white paper on 22-A lands; challenge CM to prove claims

Hyderabad: BRS leaders have strongly rejected the Chief Minister's allegations made in the Assembly, terming them “politically motivated and baseless.”

Former minister T. Harish Rao demanded a probe by a sitting Supreme Court judge and a white paper on all 22-A land transactions. Other BRS leaders said the government should focus on governance and stop distractions.



“We welcome a judicial probe. Let the truth come out. The government should stop politicising every issue.” — T. Harish Rao BRS Leader

ECONOMY & LABOUR | SOCIAL SECURITY | WORKFORCE

EPFO wage ceiling raised to ₹25,000; 51 lakh more workers to get coverage

Union Cabinet approves hike from ₹15,000 to ₹25,000, effective 17 September 2026

New Delhi: The Union Cabinet has approved raising the mandatory EPFO coverage wage ceiling from ₹15,000 to ₹25,000 per month, a move expected to bring over 51 lakh additional employees under social security.

The decision will strengthen retirement savings, improve financial security and boost formal employment, the government said.



KEY FACTS

- Wage ceiling raised ₹15,000 → ₹25,000
- 51 lakh+ additional workers to be covered
- Effective from 17 September 2026
- Broader social security and retirement benefits

NATIONAL CULTURE

INDIAN CINEMA | PRESTIGIOUS HONOUR

Veteran actor Anant Nag to receive Dadasaheb Phalke Award

Recognised for his outstanding contribution to Indian cinema; award to be presented on 22 September at 72nd National Film Awards

New Delhi: Veteran actor Anant Nag has been selected for the Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024, the highest recognition in Indian cinema, for his outstanding contribution to films.

The award will be presented at the 72nd National Film Awards ceremony in Kevadia, Gujarat, on 22 September.

Known for his versatile performances across Kannada and other Indian languages, Anant Nag's work has left a lasting impact on Indian cinema.



“Cinema has always been a medium to connect hearts and ideas. I am deeply honoured by this recognition.”

Anant Nag Dadasaheb Phalke Awardee



TELANGANA POLITICS

BRS will face 2028 on its own, says KTR

People will decide future, not alliances, asserts former minister

Hyderabad: BRS working president K.T. Rama Rao (KTR) has said the party will contest the 2028 Telangana Assembly elections independently, asserting that there will be no alliance with the BJP.

Addressing a party meeting in Hyderabad, KTR said the BRS will go before the people on the strength of its own performance, vision and commitment to Telangana's development. "There will be no alliance with the BJP. The people of Telangana will decide the future," he said.

He alleged that the BJP was indulging in "political theatrics" in the state and said the BRS remains the only party that truly understands the aspirations of Telangana.

The remarks come amid intensifying political activity in the state ahead of the 2028 elections, with parties stepping up outreach programmes.



“There will be no alliance with the BJP. We will face the 2028 elections on our own strength and on the mandate of the people of Telangana.”

— K T Rama Rao
BRS Working President

REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT

13 HI-TECH BUS STATIONS TO TRANSFORM TELANGANA'S TRANSIT NETWORK

TGSRTC plans modern facilities, commercial spaces and multimodal connectivity; construction to commence shortly

Hyderabad: The Telangana State Road Transport Corporation (TGSRTC) is set to build 13 modern hi-tech bus stations across the state under an integrated transit system model, aiming to improve passenger experience, strengthen regional connectivity and promote economic activity around transit hubs.

The proposed bus stations will feature modern passenger amenities, spacious waiting areas, food courts, retail and commercial spaces, parking facilities and seamless connections with metro, rail and other transport services. The construction is expected to commence shortly.

Stations to come up at:

- Hyderabad (Uppal)
- Karimnagar
- Khammam
- Mahabubnagar
- Suryapet
- Warangal
- Nizamabad
- Nalgonda
- Adilabad
- Siddipet
- Jagtial
- Bhupalpally



Modern Transit for a Growing Telangana

- World-class passenger amenities
- Food courts and retail spaces
- Multimodal connectivity
- Parking and EV charging
- Boost to local economy and employment

Better Mobility
Stronger Telangana

TELANGANA INCIDENT

Six boys drown during Ganesh idol immersion

Eight fell into lake near Pedda Kanjarla; two escape, six bodies recovered

Nalgonda: A tragic incident occurred near Pedda Kanjarla village when eight boys fell into a lake during the immersion of a Ganesh idol on Wednesday evening. Two boys managed to swim to safety, while six others drowned.

Rescue teams from the fire services, police and local volunteers launched a search operation and recovered all six bodies. The deceased are said to be from nearby villages.

Authorities have appealed to citizens to follow safety precautions during idol immersions, especially at deep water bodies, and ensure proper supervision of children.



Rescue teams during the search operation at Pedda Kanjarla.

TELANGANA STATE

Praja Palana Dinotsavam held across the state

Government reaffirms commitment to people's welfare, inclusive growth

Hyderabad: Telangana marked Praja Palana Dinotsavam on September 17 with a series of programmes across all districts, celebrating the beginning of a people-centric governance era.

Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy participated in the state-level event at Public Gardens, where he hoisted the national flag and outlined the government's key priorities, including social justice, welfare schemes and transparent governance.

Ministers, MLAs and district officials held flag-hoisting ceremonies, public meetings and service camps across the state, reiterating the government's commitment to inclusive development and people's welfare.



“Our government remains committed to people's welfare, social justice and a brighter Telangana for all.”

— A. Revanth Reddy
Chief Minister

ANDHRA PRADESH

High Court questions basis for 34% BC reservation in local-body elections

Seeks detailed justification from government

Amaravati: The Andhra Pradesh High Court has questioned the basis for the proposed 34% reservation for Backward Classes (BCs) in local-body elections, seeking a detailed explanation from the state government.

During the hearing, the court asked how the 34% figure was arrived at and whether it is in conformity with constitutional provisions and Supreme Court judgments. The matter has been listed for further proceedings, and the court said it will file a detailed order.



AMARAVATI DEVELOPMENT

APCRDA invites bids for key infrastructure

Amaravati: The Andhra Pradesh Capital Region Development Authority (APCRDA) has issued an invitation for bids (IFB) for the construction of key infrastructure projects in the capital city, including roads, bridges, and public facilities. The projects aim to build a modern, sustainable and well-connected capital city with world-class facilities.



DISTRICT DEVELOPMENT & LOCAL ECONOMY

Stronger Districts. A Stronger Telangana.

NALGONDA	BHADRADRI KOTHAGUDEM	MANCHERIAL	NIZAMABAD	JAYASHANKAR BHUPALPALLY	KHAMMAM	YADADRI BHUVANAGIRI	SANGAREDDY
New hospital, schools and key infrastructure	Mega Job Mela to boost youth employment	Health procurement and civic upgrades	Hospital expansion and IT investments	Vanamahotsavam keeps district green	Road works and healthcare recruitment	Dairy development under ODOP	Milk value-addition and collection centres
₹32 crore 100-bed Area Hospital at Nakreli. ₹9.85 crore Telangana Public School. ₹200 crore Young India Integrated Residential School. - Power substation works underway. ₹20 crore integrated MDO.MRO complex. ₹45.60 crore road development works.	- District administration gears up for Kodad Mega Job Mela on September 19. - Open to youth from Bhadradri Kothagudem and surrounding districts. - Participation from leading companies across sectors. - Focus on employment, skills and career guidance.	- EOI floated for supply of medical equipment to district health facilities. - Procurement for diagnostic and critical care equipment. - Tenders invited for civic and tourism infrastructure including park development, urban amenities and improvement of key public spaces.	- Government General Hospital expansion toward referral and super-specialty services. - Upgradation of medical infrastructure and new clinical blocks proposed. - Efforts on to attract IT firms and generate new job opportunities in the district.	- Large-scale plantation drive under Vanamahotsavam. - Geo-referenced plantation sites across mandals. - Participation from students, self-help groups and local communities. - Focus on increasing green cover and biodiversity conservation.	- Key road connectivity works progressing in urban and rural areas. - Recruitment underway for doctors, nurses and staff for Basti Dawakhana and Area Hospital services. - Move to strengthen primary healthcare delivery across the district.	- Dairy identified under One District One Product. - Support for value-added milk products such as paneer, ghee, curd and flavoured milk. - To promote farmer producer organisations and expand processing and marketing networks.	- Expansion of milk collection centres and bulk milk-cooling units. - Focus on value-added products including paneer, cheese, butter and flavoured milk under ODOP. - Support to dairy farmers with training, branding and market linkages.
Better Facilities Healthier Communities	More Jobs Brighter Futures	Healthy People Vibrant Towns	Better Healthcare New Opportunities	Greener District Cleaner Tomorrow	Better Roads Stronger Services	Stronger Dairy Prosperous Farmers	Local Strength Greater Opportunities

Telangana
Andhra Pradesh

People. Progress.
Brighter Tomorrows.

INTERNATIONAL
USA • INDIAN DIASPORA

New US public-charge rule takes effect from Sept 18

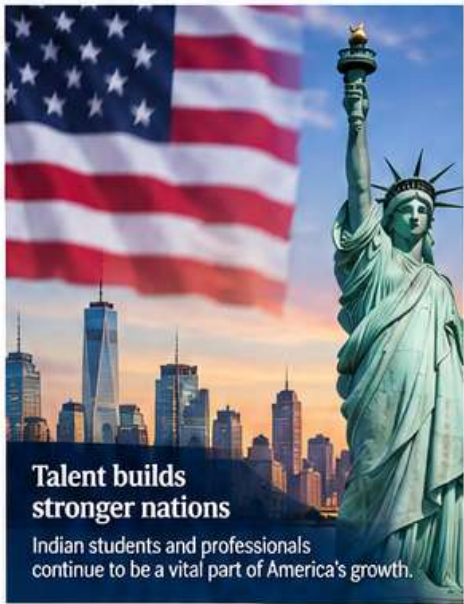
Broader factors to be considered; Indian applicants advised to be prepared with stronger documentation

Washington: The US government's revised public-charge guidance takes effect from 18 September 2026, expanding the range of factors that can be considered in immigration applications, including use of certain public benefits, financial resources, education, skills and health indicators.

The rule does not set an automatic ban, but gives immigration authorities broader discretion to evaluate whether an applicant is likely to become primarily dependent on government support.

Immigration experts say the changes could have an impact on some Indian applicants, particularly those with limited income, dependents or gaps in employment history, and advise maintaining proper documentation and financial records.

Universities and industry groups have urged the administration to ensure clarity and consistent implementation, citing the contribution of Indian students and skilled professionals to the US economy.



Talent builds stronger nations

Indian students and professionals continue to be a vital part of America's growth.

INTERNATIONAL
CHINA • INDIA

India rejects Pakistan-China boundary commission proposal

Says it has no legal basis; Modi-Xi meet focuses on stabilising ties

New Delhi: India has rejected the reported proposal for a Pakistan-China boundary commission, asserting that it has no legal basis and cannot alter India's sovereignty over its territories.

The Ministry of External Affairs said India's position on its borders remains consistent and unchanged, and that such proposals are an attempt to create confusion.

The issue came up in the backdrop of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping on 12 September 2026 in Samarkand, where both sides discussed steps to stabilise ties, maintain peace along the border and expand cooperation in trade, connectivity and people-to-people exchanges.

External Affairs officials said the focus of the meeting was on managing differences and advancing areas of cooperation in the larger interest of regional stability.



Stable Borders Stronger Futures

India remains committed to peace, dialogue and a rules-based international order.

NATIONAL **ECONOMY • DIGITAL INDIA**

UPI MDR: What Changes From October 15?

0.4% fee on select merchant payments above ₹2,000; P2P and small payments remain free

UPI MDR: At a Glance (From 15 October 2026)

Transaction type	MDR applicable?	Details
Person-to-Person (P2P)	No	Free, regardless of amount
Person-to-Merchant (P2M) ₹2,000 or below	No	Free
Person-to-Merchant (P2M) above ₹2,000	Yes	0.4% of transaction value
Cap on MDR	Yes	Maximum ₹300 (for transactions of ₹75,000 and above)
Essential services (identified categories)	No / Lower rate	Exemptions or different rates apply
Capital market transactions	No / Lower rate	Exemptions or different rates apply



“A sustainable ecosystem for a digital India”

Political reaction

- Opposition parties have demanded an immediate rollback, claiming the move will burden small businesses and ordinary people. Some leaders have alleged that the decision follows pressure from foreign payment companies.
- The government has rejected these allegations, saying the decision is based on domestic requirements and stakeholder consultations, and that consumers will not be charged the MDR and merchants are not permitted to pass it on as a separate UPI fee.

What it means for you

- ✓ No change for most users
- ✓ Everyday payments up to ₹2,000 remain free
- ✓ P2P transfers always free
- ✓ Merchants should not charge any extra fee from customers
- ✓ UPI continues to be safe, convenient and widely accessible

NATIONAL

Swachhata Hi Seva 2026 begins nationwide

Month-long campaign from Sept 17 with focus on citizen participation

New Delhi: The Swachhata Hi Seva 2026 campaign begins today, with cleanliness drives, awareness activities and community participation across the country.

The campaign aims to strengthen citizen involvement, promote waste segregation, reduce single-use plastics and encourage cleaner public spaces, with special focus on schools, RWAs, government offices and urban local bodies.

Officials said this year's initiative will include mass cleanliness drives, 'Swachhata rallies', and activities to promote a circular economy.



Clean Communities Stronger India

New Delhi: The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has announced a revised framework for Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI transactions, effective 15 October 2026. The move is aimed at making the digital payments ecosystem financially sustainable, while ensuring that small transactions and person-to-person transfers remain free.

Key features of the new framework

- A 0.4% MDR will apply to specified person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI transactions above ₹2,000 from 15 October 2026.
- The fee is capped at ₹300 for transactions of ₹75,000 and above.
- P2P transfers (sending money to family and friends) will continue to be completely free, irrespective of the amount.
- Merchant payments up to ₹2,000 will remain free.
- About 96% of P2M transactions are expected to remain unaffected, as they are ₹2,000 or below.
- Specified essential services and certain capital-market transactions will have exemptions or different rates.

Why the government says the change is needed

- Rising transaction volumes have increased costs for banks and payment service providers.
- MDR is an ecosystem fee, not a government tax, and is shared among banks, payment networks and service providers.
- The framework is intended to ensure long-term sustainability of UPI, encourage innovation, improve service quality and support healthy competition.

MUMBAI POLITICS

Maratha quota activist ends fast after government assures dialogue

Manoj Jarange calls for continued peaceful movement

Mumbai: Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange ended his 20-day fast on Wednesday after the Maharashtra government assured continued dialogue on community demands.

The government said it has noted the key demands and assured that discussions will continue within the given timeframe. Jarange appealed to supporters to maintain peace and allow the process to move forward.

Political leaders from across parties have welcomed the development, urging all stakeholders to work towards a fair and lasting solution.



“Our fight continues through dialogue, not division.”
— Manoj Jarange

CHENNAI POLITICS

Tamil Nadu parties revisit Periyar's legacy

AIADMK seeks white paper on London trip

Chennai: Political parties in Tamil Nadu are once again invoking the legacy of Periyar, with events and discussions being organised across the state.

The AIADMK has demanded a white paper on Chief Minister M.K. Stalin's recent London investment trip, seeking details of meetings, proposed investments and expected jobs.

The ruling DMK said the visit has attracted global interest in Tamil Nadu and will bring long-term benefits to the state. Political observers say the renewed focus on Periyar reflects the centrality of social justice in Tamil Nadu's political discourse.



Ideas that still inspire

BENGALURU POLITICS

Karnataka opposes Kasturirangan report implementation

Business groups raise concerns over proposed UPI charges

Bengaluru: The Karnataka government has reiterated its opposition to the implementation of the Kasturirangan report, citing potential impact on the lives and livelihoods of people in forest-fringe areas of the Western Ghats.

Chief Minister Siddaramaiah said the state will not accept any decision that affects farmers and local communities, and will continue to pursue its concerns with the Centre.

Meanwhile, trade and business associations in Bengaluru have expressed concern over the proposed UPI MDR, saying it could increase operational costs for small businesses.



Protecting People and Nature

INTERNATIONAL MARKETS

Fed Hike Reshapes Global Market Mood

US raises rates by 0.25%, signals another hike this year; dollar hits seven-week high; Asian markets mixed

Washington: The US Federal Reserve on 16 September 2026 raised its benchmark interest rate by 0.25 percentage point, marking its first rate hike in more than three years. The central bank also indicated that another hike could be possible before the end of the year, pointing to ongoing inflation risks.

The move lifted the US dollar to a seven-week high, while Asian markets were mixed on 17 September as investors weighed the impact of tighter US monetary policy. Global commodities traded softer, with Brent crude around \$104.59 a barrel and WTI near \$101.29 a barrel. Gold was trading around \$4,270 an ounce.



The Fed's rate hike marks a shift after a long pause, with markets now watching for guidance on the next move.

INDIA MARKETS

Sensex, Nifty Recover; Fed Decision Sets Today's Tone

Sensex up 332.63 points (0.45%), Nifty up 99 points (0.43%) on 16 September; investors await global cues

Mumbai: Indian equity benchmarks ended higher on 16 September 2026, tracking gains in financials and select heavyweights, even as global markets reacted to the US Fed's rate hike.

The Sensex closed at 74,336.45, up 332.63 points or 0.45%, while the Nifty 50 settled at 23,217.60, up 99 points or 0.43%.

The Nifty 50 opened at 23,201.60 during the day, it traded between 23,116.10 and 23,284.75.

Analysts said the market showed resilience despite global uncertainty, with buying seen in banking, auto and select IT stocks.



Indian markets end higher ahead of a key global week.

17 SEPT PRE-MARKET

Indian equities are set for a cautious and volatile session on 17 September, amid mixed global cues and the US Fed's rate hike. Investors are likely to track global market trends, the rupee movement and foreign institutional flows for further direction.

Global cues, FII flows and rupee trend to remain in focus.

MARKET NUMBERS

(Latest available figures / Previous close)

Nifty 50	Sensex	Brent Crude (US\$/bbl)	WTI Crude (US\$/bbl)	Gold (US\$/oz)	US 10-Year Yield
23,217.60 ▲ +99.00 (0.43%)	74,336.45 ▲ +332.63 (0.45%)	104.59 ↓	101.29 ↓	4,270 ↓	4.99% ↓

↑ STOCKS IN FOCUS (17 SEPTEMBER)

- Tempens Instruments India
- Alembic Pharmaceuticals
- Highway Infrastructure
- G R Infraprojects
- Fortis Healthcare
- Venus Pipes & Tubes
- Mazagon Dock

🚫 F&O BAN LIST (17 SEPTEMBER)

- Bandhan Bank
- Inox Wind
- Kaynes Technology India
- Manappuram Finance
- SAIL

What the Fed Move Means for Indian Investors

Stronger dollar	Higher bond yields	Foreign capital flows	Rupee under pressure	Imported inflation
A higher US rate can strengthen the dollar, making emerging market assets relatively less attractive.	US yields tend to rise after a rate hike, which can lead to outflows from equity markets in the near term.	Tighter US monetary policy may influence FII flows into India, particularly in interest rate sensitive sectors.	A stronger dollar can put pressure on the rupee, affecting import costs and corporate margins.	Costlier imports, especially crude oil, can add to inflationary pressures in India if global commodity prices remain elevated.

"The Fed's move underscores that the global interest rate environment may remain higher for longer. Indian investors will need to watch how this impacts currency, flows and corporate earnings in the coming months."

TELANGANA & ANDHRA BUSINESS

Building opportunities. Powering progress.

TELANGANA

Singapore Firms Explore Telangana Semiconductor Opportunity

Delegation led by Augustine Lee meets state leadership; expresses readiness to explore setting up a semiconductor



Hyderabad: A Singapore delegation led by Augustine Lee met Telangana's senior leadership on 16 September 2026 and expressed readiness to explore setting up a semiconductor industry in the state.

The delegation discussed investment opportunities and was briefed on Telangana's Bharat Future City project and the state's semiconductor ecosystem. The government highlighted the state's infrastructure, talent pool and policy support for global technology companies.

HYDERABAD

CCPA Fines Rapido ₹10 Lakh Over 'Pay More' Ride Prompts

Authority cites misleading ads, unfair trade practices, dark patterns; directs platform to stop the practice



New Delhi: The Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA) has imposed a penalty of ₹10 lakh on Rappan Transportation Services Pvt Ltd, the operator of ride-hailing platform Rapido, for misleading advertisements, unfair trade practices, unfair contract terms and dark patterns.

The CCPA found that Rapido's algorithm first quoted a fare to the rider and, after the rider booked at that fare, prompted the rider to pay more on the grounds that drivers were not accepting the original price. The authority held that this creates a false impression that a rider's chances of getting a ride quickly depend on paying an additional amount, amounting to "Confirm Shaming" under the 2023 Dark Patterns Guidelines. The "Set your price" interface was also found to constitute "Interface Interference" as its visual design encouraged higher payments. The CCPA has directed Rapido to discontinue such misleading prompts and practices.

ANDHRA PRADESH

Coca-Cola Bottler Lines Up ₹1,127 Crore Andhra Expansion

New production facility in Vizianagaram and expansion of Chittoor plant



Vijayawada: Hindustan Coca-Cola Beverages is set to invest ₹1,127 crore in Andhra Pradesh, including a new production facility in Vizianagaram and the expansion of its existing plant in Chittoor.

The investment is expected to enhance the company's manufacturing and distribution capabilities in the state, create employment opportunities and support the growing demand for beverages in the region.

INTERNATIONAL

Mauritius Deepens India Tourism Outreach

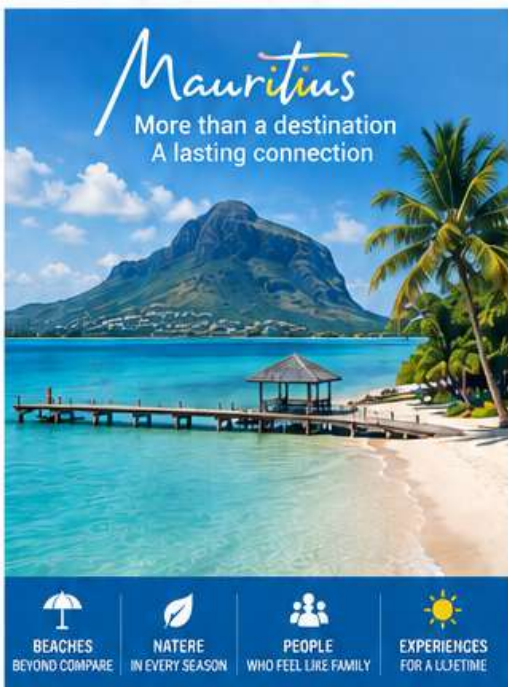
Four-city initiative includes Hyderabad today; focus on stronger tourism and people-to-people ties

Hyderabad: The Mauritius Tourism Promotion Authority (MTPA) is conducting a four-city India initiative, with Hyderabad on its schedule on 17 September 2026, as part of its renewed efforts to strengthen tourism ties with India. This is the third major India marketing operation by MTPA since January, reflecting the country's focus on the Indian market.

The initiative includes roadshows, destination presentations and meetings with travel trade partners to showcase Mauritius as a leisure, weddings and MICE (Meetings, Incentives, Conferences and Exhibitions).

Officials said the campaign aims to deepen people-to-people connections and highlight Mauritius's natural beauty, cultural diversity and warm hospitality.

India remains one of Mauritius's key source markets, with growing interest from families, honeymooners and experience travellers.



INDIA ON TRACK

Indian Railways Unveils New Facilities and Services for a Better Travel Experience

More Vande Bharat routes, upgraded stations, enhanced IRCTC services

New Delhi: Indian Railways and IRCTC have announced a series of new initiatives to improve passenger comfort, connectivity and convenience, with a focus on modern facilities and digital services.

- **New Vande Bharat Services:** Additional Vande Bharat trains to be introduced on key routes, including Hyderabad-Bengaluru and other high-demand corridors, improving connectivity in South India.
- **Station Upgrades:** Major stations across the country, including Secunderabad and Hyderabad, to get modern amenities such as improved waiting lounges, better signage, upgraded restrooms and enhanced accessibility for differently-abled passengers.
- **IRCTC Enhancements:** IRCTC is expanding its range of services with improved catering options, easier Tatkal booking through an upgraded interface, and new travel packages covering pilgrimage, heritage and tourist destinations.



Connecting People Strengthening India

- **Focus on Clean & Green:** More solar panels at stations, increased use of bio-toilets and better waste management systems are part of the sustainability push.

These initiatives aim to make train travel safer, faster, cleaner and more enjoyable for millions of passengers across the country.

NATIONAL

1,498 PM Mementoes Enter e-Auction

Eighth edition begins today; proceeds to support Namami Gange Programme

New Delhi: The eighth edition of the Prime Minister's Mementoes e-Auction begins on 17 September 2026, with 1,498 mementoes being offered to the public. The mementoes include gifts presented to the Prime Minister during national and international events, many of which reflect India's rich cultural heritage and the spirit of people's participation.

The proceeds from the auction will go to the Namami Gange Programme, supporting conservation and rejuvenation of the Ganga and its tributaries.

The e-auction provides citizens an opportunity to own a piece of history while contributing to a larger national cause.



HERITAGE & TRAVEL

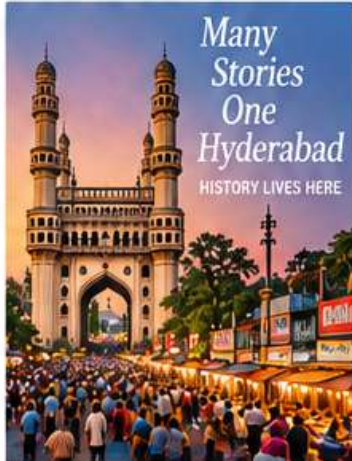
Hyderabad's Living Heritage: From Charminar to Musi

A city where history, culture and modern life flow together

Hyderabad is more than a city — it is a living museum. From the iconic Charminar and the bustling lanes of the Old City to majestic palaces, grand mosques, serene lakes and the flowing Musi, the city offers a unique blend of history, culture and contemporary charm.

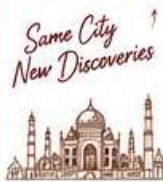
Walk through the timeless streets of Laad Bazaar, explore the magnificence of Chowmahalla Palace, witness the spiritual serenity of Mecca Masjid, and take in the lakeside beauty at Hussain Sagar. The rejuvenation of the Musi riverfront is reviving the city's historic connection with the river, opening up new possibilities for heritage walks, cultural spaces and leisure experiences.

With its gastronomic delights, vibrant markets and warm hospitality, Hyderabad offers travellers an experience that is both royal and real.



PLAN YOUR HERITAGE EXPERIENCE

- Explore iconic landmarks
- Indulge in Hyderabad's cuisine
- Take heritage walks in the Old City
- Capture timeless architecture
- Choose from heritage hotels and stays



TRAVEL DESK

Weekend Heritage Escapes from Hyderabad

Short trips, big stories



Warangal
Temples, forts and a rich Kakatiya legacy
A perfect blend of history and nature.



Bidar
Forts, palaces and a unique Deccan charm
Ideal for a quick cultural getaway.



Nagarjunakonda
Buddhist heritage amid scenic landscapes
A peaceful retreat by the river.



Hampi
A UNESCO World Heritage Site with majestic ruins
A must-visit for history lovers.

New Places Brighter Weekends

Rajasthan Domestic Travel Mart Opens

Jaipur: The three-day Rajasthan Domestic Travel Mart begins on 17 September 2026 in Jaipur, with around 300 travel operators and 700 tourism-related entities participating. The event aims to showcase Rajasthan's diverse tourism offerings, foster business collaborations and promote domestic travel across the country.



India Weather & Travel Watch

IMD forecasts widespread rain across several regions

New Delhi: The India Meteorological Department has forecast widespread rain, thunderstorms, lightning and gusty winds across multiple regions, including Telangana and Andhra Pradesh, during 17-22 September. Travellers are advised to their journeys accordingly and follow safety instructions, especially in areas prone to heavy showers and strong winds.



WELLNESS

Small Changes, Healthier You

Simple daily habits can make a big difference to your physical and mental well-being.

In today's fast-paced life, wellness doesn't require drastic changes. Experts say small, consistent habits — like staying hydrated, eating nutritious food, getting enough sleep and taking short breaks from screens — can improve energy, focus and happiness.

6 EASY HABITS FOR A HEALTHIER YOU

- 1 Start your day with water
- 2 Aim for 7–8 hours of sleep
- 3 Include more fruits and vegetables
- 4 Move for at least 30 minutes daily
- 5 Practice gratitude and stay positive

Better Habits Brighter Days

"A healthy mind and body is the real wealth."

TRAVEL

Monsoon Magic: Weekend Getaways Near Hyderabad

From misty hills to serene lakes, perfect short trips to recharge.

With the monsoon painting the surroundings in lush green, it's the perfect time for a quick weekend escape. Here are some refreshing destinations within 200 km from Hyderabad.

Short Trips Big Stories

Ananthagiri Hills (80 km)



Lush forests, trekking trails and cool weather.

Nagarjunasagar (160 km)



Majestic dam, boat rides and scenic views.

Srisaillam (213 km)



Spiritual, scenic and serene.

Bidar (145 km)



History, heritage and architecture.

"Sometimes, all you need is a change of place to find a new perspective."

FOOD & DINING

A Royal Culinary Experience Returns

Jamavar brings its celebrated Indian heritage menu to The Leela Hyderabad

Hyderabad is set for a royal culinary treat as Jamavar, the acclaimed fine-dining Indian restaurant, hosts an exclusive popup at The Leela Hyderabad on Friday, 18 September 2026. Known for its luxurious interpretation of Indian cuisine, Jamavar offers a specially curated tasting menu that celebrates the diverse culinary traditions of India.



JAMAVAR AT THE LEELA HYDERABAD

- Friday, 18 September 2026
- The Leela Hyderabad
- Royal Indian tasting menu

"A journey through India's rich culinary heritage, crafted for an unforgettable evening."

PBEL City Festive Food Carnival Spices Up Hyderabad

A 10-day celebration of flavours, fun and family time

The PBEL City Festive Food Carnival is underway at Peeranchuruvu, bringing together a wide range of cuisines, live cooking stations, cultural performances and entertainment for all age groups. From local favourites to global flavours, the event promises a great food experience with a lively festive atmosphere.



Good Food Happier People

- 13 – 23 September 2026
- PBEL City, Peeranchuruvu
- Food stalls | Live music | Family fun

"Great food brings people together."

WHAT'S HAPPENING IN HYDERABAD

Shop. Explore. Experience.

From fashion and furniture to pets and more — a season of exciting exhibitions in the city.

GOLDEN TURTLE SEASON 3

Women's Garment & Jewellery Exhibition



FASHION JEWELLERY LIFESTYLE AND MORE

A premium exhibition showcasing an exquisite range of women's garments, jewellery and lifestyle collections from top designers and brands.

- 19 – 20 September 2026
- Pradhan Conventions, Financial District, Gachibowli

DESIGN DEMOCRACY 2026

Furniture | Lighting | Kitchens | Home Accessories | Art



Ideas for a more beautiful tomorrow

A premier platform for contemporary furniture, lighting, modular kitchens, home accessories and art, bringing together leading brands and designers.

- 18 – 20 September 2026
- HITEX Exhibition Centre, Hyderabad

HI-LIFE HYDERABAD SEPTEMBER FASHION SPECIAL

Fashion | Jewellery | Lifestyle | Wedding Wear



Trends Tradition Timeless Style

A must-visit exhibition featuring a stunning range of fashion, jewellery, lifestyle products and wedding wear from top designers and labels.

- 19 – 21 September 2026
- HICC, Novotel, Hitech City, Hyderabad

PET FED HYDERABAD 2026

For a Happier, Healthier Pet Life



PETS PEOPLE COMMUNITY A HAPPIER TOMORROW

Hyderabad's biggest pet festival returns with pet products, expert sessions, fun activities, adoption drives and more. A perfect day out for pet lovers and their furry friends.

- 21 – 22 November 2026
- Novotel Hyderabad Convention Centre

Good Food Great Shopping Happier Moments

That's Hyderabad!

SEMICON INDIA 2026 OPENS AS INDIA PUSHES SILICON-TO-SYSTEMS ECOSYSTEM

Fifth edition of flagship event brings together global industry, investors and innovators from September 17–19 in New Delhi

New Delhi: SEMICON India 2026 opened today at Yashobhoomi, New Delhi, with a renewed focus on building a complete semiconductor ecosystem in India. The three-day event, from September 17 to 19, 2026, is themed 'Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem' and brings together global industry leaders, investors, policymakers, startups and research institutions.

The event showcases India's growing capabilities across chip design, manufacturing, equipment, materials, electronics, talent development and supply chain integration. It also features exhibitions, technical sessions and industry collaborations focused on a resilient and self-reliant semiconductor ecosystem.

With rising global demand and supportive government initiatives, India aims to strengthen its position in the global semiconductor value chain and accelerate electronics manufacturing growth.



SEMICON India 2026 is being held at Yashobhoomi, New Delhi, from September 17–19.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Dates**
September 17 – 19, 2026
- Venue**
Yashobhoomi, New Delhi
- Theme**
Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem
- Focus areas**
Chip design, manufacturing, materials, equipment, talent and supply chain
- Global participation**
Industry leaders, investors, startups and research institutions
- Goal**
A self-reliant and globally competitive semiconductor ecosystem for India

"From chips to solutions, India is building for a smarter, stronger tomorrow."

HOME SOLAR: HOW TO USE PM-SURYA GHAR MUFT BIJLI YOJANA

Clean energy for a brighter home and a greener tomorrow



The PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana supports households to install rooftop solar panels and reduce electricity bills. The scheme provides central financial assistance (CFA) for residential rooftop solar systems up to 3 kW capacity.

CENTRAL FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE (CFA)*

1 kW	₹30,000
2 kW	₹60,000
3 kW or higher	₹78,000

(Capped at 3 kW)
*These are scheme benchmarks, not a guarantee of final subsidy amount.

HOW TO APPLY – SIMPLE STEPS

1. Apply online at the national PM Surya Ghar portal
2. Ensure valid electricity connection
3. Check if your roof is suitable (shade-free, adequate space)
4. Choose a registered vendor from the portal
5. Installation, net-metering and commissioning
6. Start generating solar power and enjoy lower bills

- Lower electricity bills
- Cleaner environment
- A brighter, more sustainable future

WHAT ARE NITS IN MOBILE PHONES — AND WHY DO THEY MATTER?

Nits (cd/m²) measure screen brightness. Higher sustained brightness improves outdoor visibility, but there's more than just peak numbers.



UNDERSTANDING NITS

- Nits (cd/m²) measure how much light a display emits.
- Typical/Standard brightness:** Usual brightness for indoor use (typically 300–600 nits).
- High-brightness mode (HBM):** Sustained brightness for outdoor use (600–1,200+ nits).
- Peak brightness:** Maximum brightness in short bursts (1,200–2,600+ nits), useful for HDR content, but not the same as sustained brightness.

WHY IT MATTERS WHEN BUYING

- Higher sustained brightness makes the screen easier to read in sunlight.
- Peak numbers alone can be misleading — check real-world/sustained brightness.
- Also consider display type (OLED/AMOLED), contrast ratio, refresh rate (90Hz/120Hz+), resolution, colour accuracy, glare control and eye comfort features.
- A well-balanced display is better than just a high peak nit figure.

LOOK BEYOND PEAK NITS. CHOOSE A DISPLAY THAT WORKS IN YOUR WORLD.

BUYING AN ELECTRIC TWO-WHEELER? CHECK THESE KEY FEATURES

Make an informed choice with this practical buyer checklist for a smarter, cleaner and more cost-effective ride.



- Lower running cost
- Cleaner air
- Quieter cities
- A smarter commute

KEY FEATURES TO CONSIDER

1. Real-world range vs claimed range — check independent reviews
2. Battery capacity (kWh) and chemistry (LFP/NMC etc.)
3. Battery safety, BMS and Indian certification (AIS 156)
4. Charging time and home-charging practicality
5. Battery warranty and replacement terms
6. Motor power, torque and top speed
7. Load capacity and practicality for your use
8. Brakes (disc/ABS) and tyre quality
9. Suspension and ride comfort
10. IP rating for water and dust resistance
10. Connected/smart features (app, navigation, anti-theft)
10. Service network and spare-parts availability
10. Software updates and long-term support
10. Total cost of ownership (price, running cost, maintenance)

Charging time and range vary by model, charger and battery chemistry. Always check warranty terms and real-world performance before buying.

CHATGPT: 10 SMART WAYS TO GET BETTER ANSWERS

Use these simple tips to make the most of ChatGPT in your daily, study and work life.

1. State your goal clearly — tell what you want to achieve.
2. Give context — share background, relevant details or constraints.
3. Specify the audience — e.g., 'explain for a 10-year-old' or 'for a business proposal'.
4. Provide constraints — like word limit, format, tone or budget.
5. Ask for a format — bullet points, tables, step-by-step or a draft.
6. Break complex tasks into steps — get it in parts.
7. Ask for alternatives — request multiple options or different perspectives.
8. Upload or reference files — share documents, images or data for better answers.
9. Ask for verification or assumptions — 'check for errors' or 'what are the assumptions?'.
10. Refine through follow-ups — iterate with 'make it shorter', 'add examples' or 'explore more'.

USEFUL CHATGPT CAPABILITIES TODAY

- Projects**
Keep related chats, files and instructions together for a topic (e.g., business plan, travel, study).
- Study Mode**
Get step-by-step explanations, practice questions and guided learning.
- Data Analysis**
Upload spreadsheets or CSV files to analyse data, create charts and get insights.

BETTER QUESTIONS. BRIGHTER ANSWERS.

QUANTUM COMPUTING MOVES TOWARD INDUSTRIAL SCALE

IBM announces \$1 billion US government-backed quantum-chip foundry



New York: IBM has announced a \$1 billion government-backed initiative to build a quantum-chip foundry in the United States, marking a significant step toward industrial-scale quantum computing.

The facility aims to advance the manufacturing of quantum chips, improve performance and support wider commercial deployment.

Experts say quantum computing has the potential to solve complex problems in materials science, drug discovery, optimisation and cybersecurity, but large-scale commercial applications are still a few years away.

“Technology works best when it makes life simpler, cleaner and brighter for everyone.”



Smarter Technology A Brighter Tomorrow

BOLLYWOOD

Salman Khan gears up for Bigg Boss 20, celebrates Ganesh Chaturthi with family

Actor says the new season will be 'more real, more human'

Mumbai: Salman Khan is all set to return as the host of *Bigg Boss 20*, with preparations for the new season in full swing. The actor has hinted that this season will bring "more real, more human" conversations, while retaining the drama and entertainment the show is known for.

Recently, Salman celebrated Ganesh Chaturthi with his family at his Mumbai residence. Photos and videos from the festivities, featuring Salman with his parents Salim Khan and Salma Khan, along with family members, went viral on social media.

Interacting with the media, Salman said *Bigg Boss* has always been close to his heart and that he looks forward to another exciting season with a strong mix of personalities and unexpected moments.

"The audience connects with honesty. We try to keep it real, and that's what makes the show special," he said.



DRAMA
CONVERSATIONS
CELEBRITIES
COMMONERS
A NEW JOURNEY

TOLLYWOOD

'THE PARADISE' BUILDS MOMENTUM FOR SEPTEMBER 24 RELEASE

Nani and team kick off multi-city promotional tour; grand pre-release event in Hyderabad on September 21

Hyderabad: Natural Star Nani's much-awaited film *The Paradise*, directed by Srikanth Odela, is all set for a theatrical release on September 24, 2026. The team has begun a multi-city promotional tour, with events in Chennai today (September 17), Bengaluru on September 18, and Kochi on September 19.

A grand pre-release event will be held in Hyderabad on September 21, with the film's cast and crew expected to attend. The makers have been releasing impactful posters and promotional content, which have generated strong buzz among audiences.

The Paradise is billed as an intense action drama set against a raw and rustic backdrop. Fans are eagerly expected to be one of the biggest Telugu releases of the year.



"A story of survival, belonging and a world that never forgets." – Team The Paradise

BOX OFFICE

Hanuman Ansh Continues Strong Run

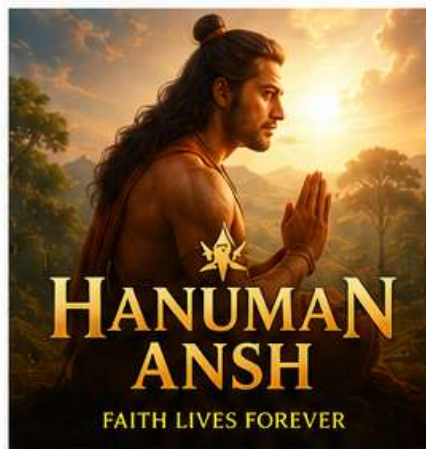
Crosses ₹291 crore worldwide as per Koimoi (16 September 2026)

Mumbai: The mythological drama *Hanuman Ansh* continues to impress audiences, with strong numbers at the box office. According to figures reported by Koimoi on September 16, the film has crossed ₹231.13 crore in India net collection (40 days), ₹272.78 crore in India gross, and ₹291.28 crore worldwide gross. The film, made on an ₹1.8 crore, has emerged as a surprise success with its mythological theming.

HANUMAN ANSH - BOX OFFICE FIGURES (AS REPORTED BY KOIMOI ON 16 SEPTEMBER 2026)

India Net Collection (40 days)	₹ 231.13 crore
India Gross Collection	₹ 272.78 crore
Overseas Gross Collection	₹ 18.50 crore
Worldwide Gross Collection	₹ 291.28 crore
Day 40 India Net (approx.)	₹ 8.25 crore
Film Budget (approx.)	₹ 1.8 crore

Note: Figures are as per Koimoi, reported on 16 September 2026. Collections are estimates and may vary across sources.



"A remarkable run at the box office, proving the power of good content and audience connect."

HYDERABAD LIVE MUSIC

Your City, Your Music: Exciting Concerts Ahead

From classical fusions to indie and blockbuster tours, Hyderabad gears up for a vibrant music season.



Federal Bank Bharat Surotsav
A celebration of India's rich musical heritage with leading artistes from across genres.
19 September 2026
Shilpakala Vedika, Hyderabad



Lifafa Live in Hyderabad
The popular indie band Lifafa brings their signature sound to the city.
25 September 2026
BPM, Hyderabad



OG Tour India – Thaman (Live)
Blockbuster composer Thaman's high-energy live concert as part of the OG Tour India.
24 October 2026
Gachibowli Stadium, Hyderabad

Live the music. Feel the city.

HOLLYWOOD

Jean Smart Makes Emmys History

Wins record fourth Emmy for *Hacks*, becoming the most awarded actor in Emmy history



Jean Smart with her Emmy Award (AP)

Los Angeles: Jean Smart has made Emmy history at the 78th Primetime Emmy Awards (2026), winning the Outstanding Lead Actress in a Comedy Series for *Hacks*. With this win, Smart now holds the record for the most Emmy acting wins of all time, surpassing previous records and further cementing her legacy as one of television's greatest performers.

In her heartfelt acceptance speech, Smart thanked the cast, crew and fans, saying, "It's a privilege to keep doing what I love."

GLOBAL MUSIC

International Music Comes to India

From Coldplay to Maroon 5, 2026 is a blockbuster year for global concerts in India



Coldplay Music of the Spheres
18 & 19 January 2026
D.Y. Patil Stadium, Navi Mumbai



Maroon 5
3 February 2026
Mahalaxmi Racecourse, Mumbai



Ed Sheeran
14 February 2026
Levi's® Stadium, Bengaluru

"Music has no borders. India feels the beat."

FESTIVE HYDERABAD

Hyderabad's Ganesh Mandaps Turn Devotion Into Art

From towering idols to thematic wonders, the city celebrates faith, culture and creativity

Hyderabad is wearing a festive look as Ganesh mandaps across the city attract devotees with grand idols, unique themes and artistic showcases. From record-breaking heights to rare ornaments and replicas of iconic temples, this year's celebrations highlight the city's devotion and creative spirit.

Thousands of devotees have been visiting major mandaps since the weekend, with special arrangements for darshan, annadanam and cultural programmes.



"Ganesh festivities in Hyderabad are not just about worship, but a celebration of art, community and the city's unique spirit."

*Ganapati
Bappa
Morya!*

KHAIRATABAD BADA GANESH 69-foot Panchamukha draws lakhs of devotees



- 69-foot Panchamukha Sankatahara Maha Ganapati with five faces.
- Special displays include Somnath Jyotirlinga and Kali Mata.
- One of the biggest attractions in the country, drawing devotees from across India.
- Elaborate arrangements for darshan, lighting and crowd management.

BALAPUR GANESH Puri Jagannath Temple theme wows devotees



- This year's Balapur Ganesh mandap recreates the Puri Jagannath Temple.
- Nearly 70 artists worked on the intricate set-up with traditional art forms.
- The entire arrangement is reported to have been made at a cost of around ₹40 lakh.
- A major crowd-puller for its devotional ambience and detailed craftsmanship.

FEELKHANA / BEGUM BAZAAR 24-karat gold Ganesh adorned with 3.83 lakh diamonds



- A spectacular idol coated with 24-karat gold and adorned with more than 3.83 lakh American diamonds.
- Known for its grandeur and unique design every year.
- Attracts huge footfall, especially during evening hours.
- A blend of devotion and fine craftsmanship that reflects Hyderabad's rich artisanal tradition.

TRAFFIC POLICE UPDATE

Ganesh Rush: Traffic Plan Tightened

Diversions, barricades and special arrangements in place around Khairatabad



- Hyderabad Traffic Police are managing heavy festival crowds, with diversions imposed as and when required around Khairatabad and adjoining areas.
- More than 30 lakh devotees are expected to visit Khairatabad Bada Ganesh during the festival.
- Barricades, pedestrian queues and additional police personnel have been deployed for smooth movement.
- Devotees are advised to use Metro, MMTS and RTC services. The Prasads/IMAX side is one of the identified access and parking approaches.
- Major traffic impact is expected on NTR Marg, Necklace Road, Mint Compound, Secretariat and nearby junctions.
- Continuous monitoring is being done through CCTV cameras and drone surveillance.



Cooperate with traffic police, follow diversions and use public transport for a safe and hassle-free darshan.

HYDERABAD WEATHER DESK

Partly Cloudy, Possibility of Thunder

No weather warning for the city

THU, 17 SEP 2026



33°C
Max
24°C
Rain Min

Partly cloudy sky with possibility of thunder and lightning. No warning.

5-DAY FORECAST

Fri 18 Sep	Sat 19 Sep	Sun 20 Sep	Mon 21 Sep	Tue 22 Sep
32°C --- ---	31°C --- ---	31°C --- ---	30°C 23°C	30°C 23°C

IMMERSION ARRANGEMENTS

NECKLACE ROAD-TANK BUND: IMMERSION PLAN TIGHTENED

Warning boards, barricades and designated immersion points guide devotees as police step up monitoring



Awareness boards installed along Necklace Road and Tank Bund to guide devotees during Ganesh immersion.

- Hyderabad Police and GHMC have installed flex banners and awareness boards at Hussain Sagar and Tank Bund stating that Ganesh idol immersion should not be carried out at Tank Bund.
- As per Telangana High Court directions, PoP idols should not be immersed in Hussain Sagar.
- Additional platforms and cranes are being arranged along the Necklace Road shoreline to facilitate immersion.
- Organisers and devotees are being directed toward designated immersion points such as Necklace Road and NTR Gardens.
- Check-posts, barricades, CCTV monitoring and signage have been put in place to ensure smooth and safe proceedings.



*Different
paths,
One prayer,
A brighter
Hyderabad.*

CITY AT A GLANCE

- Prefer public transport (Metro/MMTS/RTC)
- Follow barricades and police directions
- Expect traffic delays around festival corridors
- Carry rain protection (umbrella or raincoat)
- Be patient, be kind and keep the city clean

*A City United
in Devotion*